

DESK PORTAL

User Guide

A multi-tenant PSA ticket portal — for clients, technicians, managers, and administrators.

Version 0.1.0

This guide covers everyday use of the portal: raising and following tickets, the productivity dashboards, and administering PSA connections and field mappings.

1. Getting started

Signing in

Open the portal and choose **Continue with SSO**. Authentication is handled by your organization's identity provider — you'll be returned to the dashboard once signed in. Your name and a **Sign out** option appear at the top right.

Finding your way around

The left sidebar is your main navigation. On a phone it collapses into a scrollable bar at the top. A light/dark theme toggle sits at the top right.

- **Tickets** — raise and follow support requests.
- **Internal boards** — the work your team does for itself, and alerts from monitoring (staff).
- **Productivity, Technician hours, Client workload** — how the desk is doing (staff).
- **Scheduled reports** — reports that send themselves (staff).
- **PSA Connections, Field Mapping, Integration Health, Background Jobs, Audit Log** — administration.

2. Raising & following tickets

Create a ticket

Go to **Tickets** → **New ticket**. Give it a short title, choose a priority, and describe the issue. On submit, the ticket is created in your provider's system (the PSA) and appears in your list.

Track progress

- The **ticket list** shows status, priority, queue and when each was raised.
- Open a ticket to see its **public conversation** and add a reply.
- **Attach files** from the ticket detail — they are scanned for malware; executables are blocked; 25 MB max. Only clean files can be downloaded.
- **Notifications** lists recent activity on your tickets.

Internal notes your support team writes are never shown in the portal — you only ever see public replies.

3. Working a ticket (staff)

Open a ticket and use the box at the top of the conversation. One action covers the three things you usually do at once: say what happened, move the ticket on, and record your time.

- **Internal note** is selected first, because most of what you write is for the team. It never reaches the client.
- **Public reply** appears only when the ticket has a contact who would actually receive it. On an internal board there is no client to reply to, so it is not offered at all.
- **Set status** changes the ticket as you post, rather than as a second step you might forget.
- **Log time** records hours against the ticket, with the reply they belong to. There is a timer if you prefer to start it and forget it.

Assign or hand over

Assign technician sets who is working the ticket. On an internal board you can also leave a **handover note** — what the next person should read first — which is kept with the handover, so a night shift picks up where the day shift left off instead of guessing.

You can also route a ticket to a **team** — Level 2, NOC — as well as to a person. A ticket can sit with a team before anyone picks it up, and stays with the team once someone does.

A ticket that came from a PSA also shows a link that opens it in that system, for the things the portal deliberately does not duplicate.

Follow a ticket

Follow puts a ticket in your own **Following** view without taking it on — for the ticket you escalated, or the customer you look after. **Add somebody** does the same for a colleague. Following never changes who is working the ticket.

Tasks

Break a ticket into steps under **Tasks** — order the part, fit it, update the register. Tick each one off as it is done; the portal records who ticked it and when. A ticket cannot be closed from the portal while any of its tasks is still open. Tasks are for your team only and are never sent to a PSA or shown to a client.

Canned responses and formatting

- **Canned response** in the reply box inserts a saved reply, filled in with this ticket's number, customer, contact and your name. Edit it as you like before sending.
- The toolbar formats the text: bold, italic, lists, quotes, code, links and tables.
- Paste a screenshot straight into the reply box and it is attached to the reply.

Some PSAs, Autotask among them, show formatting as the marks you typed rather than as formatting.

Find a ticket

- The **search box** at the top of every page (Ctrl+/) finds ticket numbers, subjects, customers and, once you have typed four characters, words in the replies. Press Enter to see every match as a list.
- The **views** above the ticket list — Open, Mine, Unassigned, Overdue, Following, Closed — are one click each. **Mine** includes tickets sitting with a team you are in.
- Set any filters you use often, then **Save this view**. Tick **Share with the team** to offer it to everyone; only you can change or delete it.

4. Internal boards (staff)

Not every job comes from a PSA. **Internal boards** hold the work your team does for itself and for each other: tasks you assign between shifts, project work, and anything a client has asked for that never reached their PSA. Nothing on a board is sent to a PSA, and nothing on an internal board is visible to a client.

- **Raise a ticket** on a board and assign it to anyone on the team. Everybody can assign to everybody.
- Pick **what it is about** — a topic such as Patching or Access request — and the department, priority, assignee and due date that kind of work usually has are filled in for you. Change any of it: the topic is a shortcut, not a rule. Leads set the topics up under **Topics** on the board.

- Record **how it reached us** (phone, email, chat, someone at the desk, a meeting) so the question of where your work comes from can be answered later.
- A **due date** shows in the list, with overdue in red and anything due within eight hours marked soon.
- Each board has its own numbers, such as **INT-000123**, which is what people quote to each other.
- You can name the **client** a piece of work was for. It records who it was for — it does not show the ticket to them.
- A board with no members belongs to the whole team. Leads and administrators can narrow a board to named people.
- Creating and configuring boards is limited to leads and administrators; raising and assigning is not.

SLA plans

Leads set up **SLA plans** under **Internal boards** → **SLA plans**: a first reply within so many hours and resolution within so many, counted round the clock or in working hours only. Give a plan to a topic, or make it a board's default, and each new ticket shows **First reply** and **Resolution** dates, marked met, late or overdue. The board list shows **Reply by** until somebody writes on the ticket.

Alerts from monitoring tools

A board of the **monitoring** kind can be fed by NinjaOne, Datto RMM or anything else that can post JSON. Under **Internal boards** → **Monitoring tools**, connect a tool and copy the key it shows you into that tool's webhook, along with the address on the same page.

- The same alert arriving repeatedly updates one ticket rather than opening a pile of them.
- When the tool says the condition cleared, the ticket closes itself.
- If the same fault returns within a day, that ticket reopens instead of a second one appearing.
- The client the tool names is matched against your customer list; a name nobody recognises is reported back rather than guessed at.

The key is shown once, when it is issued, because only a fingerprint of it is stored. If it is lost or leaks, issue a new one — the old one stops working immediately.

5. Productivity dashboards (staff)

The **Productivity** page shows technician and team metrics: assigned, resolved, open and overdue tickets, SLA compliance, average resolution time, and time worked. A configurable **productivity score** combines several signals into a single number, with a breakdown per component. Use **Export CSV** to download the team view.

Technician hours

Technician hours shows each person's hours and output over any period — today, yesterday, this or last month, this or last quarter. Client work and internal work are shown side by side rather than blended: hours for clients, hours on the team's own boards, and tickets resolved on each side. Export the same table by name for a spreadsheet or a review.

Productivity scores are operational indicators only and must not be used as the sole basis for employee performance decisions. The score only counts signals that are actually measured, and reports how much of the model that covers.

6. Administration

PSA Connections

Connect Autotask and ConnectWise tenants under **PSA Connections**.

- **Add connection** — name it, choose the provider, enter the API endpoint and credentials. Credentials are stored in a secure secret vault, never in the database and never shown again.
- **Edit** — change settings; leave the credential fields blank to keep the existing keys, or enter new ones to rotate.
- **Test** — runs a live check against the PSA and updates the connection's health status.
- **Boards** — discovers the connection's service boards/queues, statuses, priorities and categories live.

Rotating PSA credentials

If an API key is ever exposed, rotate it promptly. The portal is built so this needs no redeploy and no code or config changes:

- In your PSA, revoke the exposed key and generate a new one. In **ConnectWise Manage** this is **System** → **Members** → **API Members**: open the member, delete the old key pair on the **API Keys** tab, then create a new pair. The new private key is shown only once — copy it immediately.
- In the portal, open **PSA Connections** → **Edit** for that connection and enter the new credentials. Sensitive fields are masked and are never pre-filled, so type the new key(s) and save.
- Leaving a credential field blank keeps the current value; only the fields you fill are overwritten in the secret vault.
- Click **Test** to confirm the new key works, then check **Integration Health**.

Never paste API keys into chat, tickets, email, code, or config files. The portal only accepts credentials through the masked fields on this screen, which write straight to the secret vault — treat any key that has been shared anywhere else as compromised and rotate it.

Field Mapping

Under **Field Mapping**, translate the portal's neutral values to each PSA's real values — this is how the portal and your PSA agree on what a status, priority, queue or category means.

- Pick a **connection** and a **field** (Status, Priority, Queue/Board, Category).
- For status and priority, map each portal value to a discovered PSA value.
- For queues and categories, add a mapping by naming a portal value and picking the PSA value.
- Each save is stored as a new **version** and recorded in the audit log, so changes can be reviewed.

Scheduled reports

Under **Scheduled reports**, set the organization's time zone and create reports that send themselves: technician productivity daily, weekly, monthly or quarterly, and a client business review each quarter. Each runs at 07:00 in your time zone, covering the last complete period, and arrives as a PDF with a spreadsheet beside it. Every run is kept in the portal to download even if email is not set up.

Email delivery

Reports need an account to send from. On **Integration Health**, use **Set up email**. Microsoft 365 is the recommended route: create an app registration with the **Mail.Send** permission and enter its tenant and client IDs and secret. Mail then leaves from a real mailbox, which is what keeps it out of

Junk. A plain mail server with a username and password also works. **Send test email** proves it before anyone relies on it.

Needs attention

Integration Health opens with one list of what is quietly going wrong: connections that failed or stopped syncing, tickets that never reached the PSA, closed tickets with no closed date, and reports nobody received. Add recipients and the same list is emailed each morning, but only on days something is on it.

Monitoring & audit

- **Integration Health** — per-connection status, pending jobs, dead-lettered jobs and failed events.
- **Background Jobs** — monitor sync jobs and **reprocess** any that dead-lettered.
- **Audit Log** — an immutable record of administrative and security events (connection changes, mapping updates, tests, job reprocessing).

7. Security & your data

- Each organization's data is fully isolated — you only ever see your own.
- PSA credentials live only in the secret vault; they are never returned to the browser or written to logs or the audit trail.
- Access is governed by role-based permissions (client user, client administrator, technician, manager, administrator, auditor).
- Attachments are validated and malware-scanned; downloads use short-lived, signed links.

8. Getting help

If a page shows a “sign in” or empty state where you expect data, your session may have expired — sign in again. For anything else, contact your MSP administrator, who can review the audit log and integration health to diagnose issues.